

7.8 Network Analysis Tools

7.7.1 Ethereal (www.ethereal.com)

Ethereal is a network packet analyser—it captures network packets and then displays that packet data in as much detail as possible. It operates on the Network layer.

The tool is used by network engineers for troubleshooting and analysis. It is also used as a test bed for software and protocol development. Ethereal runs on all popular computing platforms, including Linux and Windows.



Ethereal in action

Ethereal captures traffic from various network media apart from Ethernet. The support for a media type is determined by factors such as the operating system being used. Ethereal can open/save packets captured from/to a large number of other capture programs.

Windows Installation

The user can install directly from the Ethereal installer. However, to install the tool through the command line, certain parameters are:

- (i) /NCRC disables the CRC check
- (ii) /S runs the installer or uninstaller with default values.
- (iii) /desktopicon installation of the desktop icon, where “=yes” amounts to force installation, and “=no” to deny installation.
- (iv) /quicklaunchicon is for the installation of quick launch icon, where “=yes” and “=no” mean the same as above.
- (v) /D sets the default installation directory (\$INSTDIR).

Example: `ethereal-setup-0.10.13.exe /NCRC /S /desktopicon=yes /quicklaunchicon=no /D=C:\Program Files\Foo`